
Paper 1, Option 1A: The crusades, c1095–1204

Overview

This option comprises a study in breadth of the early crusading movement from the late eleventh to the early thirteenth century. It has continued relevance as, even today, the crusades exercise a powerful influence in many countries of the Near East, and their legacy continues to shape relations with Europe and the world.

The focus of study is on developments and changes over a broad timescale and so the content is presented as themes spanning a significant period: 1095–1192. This option also contains a study in depth of historical interpretations on a broad question that is contextualised by, and runs on from, the themes: reasons for the failure of the Fourth Crusade.

Themes	Content
1 Reasons for the crusades, 1095–1192	• Religious motives: the concept of 'just war'; the impact of the papal reform movement on ideas of penance and remission of sins; guarantees of plenary indulgence; the aim of freeing Jerusalem; papal support for the crusades; the influence of preachers, including Bernard of Clairvaux. • Political motives: threats to the Byzantine Empire; Alexius I Comnenus's appeal to Urban II; the political ambitions of the papacy; Urban's political problems in Germany and France; violence and growing disorder in Europe; the Second and Third Crusades and the defence of the crusader states. • The knights and the crusades: the nature of knighthood in the late eleventh century; the development of the concept of chivalry; protecting Christianity and pilgrims; settlement in the crusader states and the acquisition of wealth.
2 Leadership of the crusades, 1095–1192	• The First Crusade: the eight princes and their changing priorities; Baldwin's conquest of Edessa 1097; Bohemund's seizure of Antioch 1098; emergence of Godfrey of Bouillon as leader and the capture of Jerusalem 1099. • Louis VII, Conrad III and the Second Crusade: personal and political rivalries and tensions; their relationship with Manuel I; the failure to consult the leaders of the crusader states; failure at Damascus 1148 and the end of the crusade. • The troubled leadership of the Third Crusade: the significance of the death of Frederick Barbarossa; the rivalries of Richard I and Philip II; Richard's decision to attack Sicily and Cyprus; Philip's return to France. Richard's leadership at Acre and Jaffa and reasons for his decision not to attack Jerusalem.

Themes	Content
3 The crusader states of Outremer, 1100–92	• Geography and economy: Edessa, Tripoli, Antioch and the primacy of Jerusalem; the absence of natural boundaries to the east; the importance of the seaports for maintaining economic and military links with Europe; trade between Muslim and Christian cities; patterns of settlement and migration from Europe. • Defence: Baldwin I's consolidation of territory, 1100–18; adoption of local methods of fortification and the building of castles; the protection of the military orders of Templars and Hospitallers, including their control of border castles; financial support for the military orders by European nobles; lack of support for the states from Byzantium and Europe. • The government of the crusader states: the rule of Baldwin I and Baldwin II; Baldwin III and the conflict with Queen Melisende; the rule of the 'leper king' Baldwin IV; the importance of growing divisions within the ruling elite and the succession crisis of 1185; the significance of Raymond of Tripoli's truce with Saladin.
4 The changing Muslim response to the crusades, 1095–1192	• Muslim political and religious divisions: the split between the Sunni Seljuk Turks and the Shi'ah Fatimids of Egypt; the significance of Kilij Arslan's defeats at Nicaea and Dorylaeum 1097; the defeat of Kerbogha's forces at Antioch 1098; the fall of Jerusalem 1099. • The growth of Muslim power, 1144–69: Zengi and the seizure of Edessa 1144; Nur ad-Din's consolidation of power, 1146–54. Nur's growing rift with Saladin. • The power of Saladin, 1169–92: consolidation of Saladin's power in Egypt and Syria, 1169–84; the attack on Tiberias, the battle of Hattin and fall of Jerusalem to Saladin 1187; the siege of Acre and the battle of Arsuf, 1189–91; Saladin's success in keeping Muslim control of Jerusalem in 1192.

Historical interpretations	Content
What explains the failure of the Fourth Crusade?	• Innocent III's plans for the crusade and the significance of their failure. • The significance of the size and leadership of the crusading forces. • The impact of the role of Venice and of the priorities of the Doge Enrico Dandolo. • The significance of the failure of Prince Alexius and of the sack of Constantinople.